

Figure 1: The GNOME extensions website



Figure 3: The GNOME Tweak Tool Shell Extensions screen

Cinnamon are not at all compatible, their extensions will not work without certain changes being made. If you are using Linux Mint, you can switch between GNOME Shell and Cinnamon with `gnome-shell --replace` and `cinnamon --replace` respectively. Make sure you kill the associated process and shell before switching, unless you want to leak system memory.

The best way to install extensions in GNOME is to use `gnome-tweak-tool` a.k.a. *Advanced Settings*, a one-stop-shop for editing GNOME Shell properties and installing or changing themes, shell extensions and various other eye-candy. Make sure you have the `gnome-shell-extension` package installed; else you will not be able to install extensions using `gnome-tweak-tool`.

Manual installation: There are many ways to install the extension manually. If you are using the GNOME extensions website, then just click the *On/Off* slider; installation will begin automatically. If you have cloned the source code for the extension, you can simply copy the extension in `/usr/share/gnome/extension` for system-wide (for all users) installation, or to `~/local/share/gnome/extension` for a single user. Make sure to restart the shell after this; press `ALT+F2`, type `r` and hit `Enter`. GNOME Shell will restart, and all installed extensions should be active.

Must-have GNOME extensions

If you head to the GNOME extensions website, you will find a not-so-user-friendly interface, and not many options to find

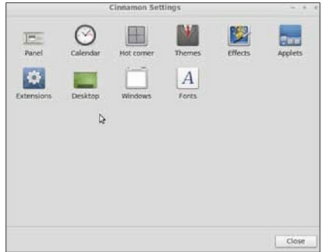


Figure 2: The Linux Mint Cinnamon tweak tool



Figure 4: Weather extension in action

the best of the bunch. Most extensions are either too basic or too fragile to be used in a stable desktop. So I have selected some of the best for you.



Note: It's possible that the extension will not work, courtesy the broken version control at the GNOME end. If you are using a somewhat older revision, you may have to update it first.

Weather: For those who love to know about the weather, there's a cool extension that shows the latest updates in a beautiful graphical pattern, along with basic pressure, humidity and wind speed data, as well as forecasts for two days. This extension is not available from the GNOME extensions website; you can grab and compile source code from Git, or use the PPA for Ubuntu-based distros. To get the Git source, run `git clone git://github.com/simon04/gnome-shell-extension-weather.git`. For a PPA, use the following commands:

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:webupd8team/gnome3
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install gnome-shell-extensions-weather
```

The GPaste clipboard: If you're missing trusty old clipboard tools such as Klipper and GNOME clipboard, do not worry. GPaste fills the gap. It works pretty well, and lets you track your old clips and even back them up. Unfortunately,